

15 Jul 2026 06:00:00 ET | 14 pages

Intel Corp (INTC.O)

Preview: Investor Focus on Foundry Customers & CPU Demand

CITI'S TAKE

Intel reports earnings on July 23 after the market close. Our 2Q26 sales/EPS of \$14.4B (up 6% Q/Q)/\$0.24 is above Consensus of \$14.36B/\$0.21 and we model 3Q26 sales/EPS of \$15.1B (up 5% Q/Q)/\$0.29, above Consensus on CPU upside and opex discipline. We expect data center sales to upside in 2026 driven by better-than-expected CPU demand and custom ASIC sales. We model Intel foundry sales to scale in 2027 driven by EMIB packaging, Apple, Nvidia, Media Tek, and Terafab. Maintain Buy.

Expect 2026 data center upside — We model Intel's data center segment to grow to \$23.1B in 2026 (up 37% YoY), above Consensus of \$22.8B (up 35% YoY) on better-than-expected server CPU demand and ASIC business scaling. Intel's ASIC IPU business (e.g. Google Mount Evans) is now running north of \$1B in annualized revenue and we expect LLM maker using TPUs to layer on the top of it.

Intel foundry sales to scale in 2027 — We model Intel external foundry sales of \$4.6B in 2027 and \$10B in 2028 driven by EMIB packaging and multiple foundry wafer customers. Moreover, Intel should be a major beneficiary of Space X initiative to support Terafab, in our view (please see Citi's [SPCX initiation](#)).

Expanding Ireland Fab Capacity — This week, Intel announced a \$5.7B capex investment to expand and upgrade Ireland fab. The news supports CPU demand and is a positive readthrough for Intel Foundry. CEO Lip Bu has previously stated "I think the best indication, when you see I increase my capex, I'm putting money to buy equipment, that means I have real customers. That's the discipline I have."

Expect below Seasonal 2H26 on CCG — Intel expects client CPU sales to increase in 2Q26 (Citi up 2% Q/Q) and previously expects a below seasonal 2H26 with PC CPU TAM to be down low double digits Y/Y in 2026 on memory supply constraints.

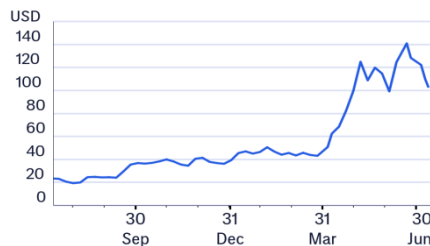
Focus on the call — We believe the key focus areas on the call are: 1) Intel Foundry customer traction, 2) Server CPU demand and TAM assumptions, 3) Capex outlook, 4) 18A and 14A progress, and 5) PC outlook.

Buy

Price (14 Jul 26 16:00)	US\$107.76
Target price	US\$130.00
Expected share price return	20.6%
Expected dividend yield	0.0%
Expected total return	20.6%
Market Cap	US\$541,602M

Price Performance

(RIC: INTC.O, BB: INTC US)



EPS (US\$)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	FY	FC Cons	VA Cons
2025A	-0.02A	-0.25A	0.10A	0.05A	-0.12A	0.42A	0.42A
2026E	0.17A	0.12E	0.17E	0.21E	0.67E	1.09E	1.11E
Previous	0.17A	0.12E	0.17E	0.21E	0.67E	na	na
2027E	0.20E	0.27E	0.36E	0.44E	1.27E	1.57E	1.60E
Previous	0.20E	0.27E	0.36E	0.44E	1.27E	na	na
2028E	0.41E	0.46E	0.57E	0.67E	2.11E	2.52E	2.61E
Previous	0.41E	0.46E	0.57E	0.67E	2.11E	na	na

Source: Company Reports and dataCentral, Citi Research. FC Cons: First Call Consensus. VA Cons: Visible Alpha Consensus.

Click [here](#) for Visible Alpha consensus data

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

INTC.Q: Fiscal year end 31-Dec						Price: US\$107.76; TP: US\$130.00; Market Cap: US\$541,602m; Recomm: Buy					
Profit & Loss (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	53,101	52,853	58,577	64,700	72,400	PE (x)	na	na	na	84.8	51.1
Cost of sales	-34,877	-34,062	-34,932	-35,504	-35,577	PB (x)	4.3	3.7	3.9	3.6	3.3
Gross profit	18,224	18,791	23,645	29,196	36,823	EV/EBITDA (x)	72.9	45.4	31.5	25.0	19.5
Gross Margin (%)	34.3	35.6	40.4	45.1	50.9	FCF yield (%)	-0.1	-1.2	1.3	1.1	0.8
EBITDA (Adj)	7,715	12,188	17,091	21,242	26,860	Dividend yield (%)	0.3	na	na	na	na
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	14.5	23.1	29.2	32.8	37.1	Payout ratio (%)	-40	0	0	0	0
Depreciation	-9,951	-10,757	-11,279	-11,615	-12,241	ROE (%)	-3.8	-0.4	2.6	4.6	6.9
Amortisation	-1,428	-949	-967	-966	-964	Cashflow (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBIT (Adj)	-3,664	482	4,845	8,662	13,655	EBITDA	7,550	12,099	17,074	21,242	26,860
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	-6.9	0.9	8.3	13.4	18.9	Working capital	1,103	-1,747	-1,631	-499	-409
Net interest	0	0	0	0	0	Other	14,811	-790	7,336	1,561	1,007
Associates	0	0	0	0	0	Operating cashflow	23,464	9,562	22,779	22,305	27,458
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	70	-274	340	40	40	Capex	-23,944	-14,646	-15,409	-16,175	-22,769
Pre-tax profit	-3,594	208	5,185	8,702	13,695	Net acq/disposals	0	0	0	0	0
Tax	-463	-317	-667	-1,044	-1,643	Other	-736	352	-40	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	0	-396	-1,079	-1,100	-1,100	Investing cashflow	-24,680	-14,294	-15,449	-16,175	-22,769
Reported net profit	-4,057	-505	3,440	6,558	10,952	Dividends paid	-1,599	0	0	0	0
Net Margin (%)	-7.6	-1.0	5.9	10.1	15.1	Financing cashflow	-556	-2,979	-1,471	-3,078	-3,093
Core NPAT	-4,057	-505	3,440	6,558	10,952	Net change in cash	-1,772	-7,711	5,860	3,052	1,596
Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Free cashflow to s/holders	-480	-5,084	7,370	6,130	4,689
Reported EPS (\$)	-0.98	-0.12	0.67	1.27	2.11						
Core EPS (\$)	-0.93	-0.12	0.67	1.27	2.11						
DPS (\$)	0.38	0	0	0	0						
CFPS (\$)	5.37	2.36	4.45	4.32	5.29						
FCFPS (\$)	-0.11	-1.26	1.44	1.19	0.90						
BVPS (\$)	25.35	28.79	27.77	29.78	32.99						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	4,144	4,389	4,985	5,020	5,051						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	4,370	4,044	5,122	5,159	5,190						
Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Sales revenue (%)	-2.1	-0.5	10.8	10.5	11.9						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	-354.8	113.2	905.2	78.8	57.6						
Core NPAT (%)	-426.1	87.6	781.1	90.7	67.0						
Core EPS (%)	-430.6	86.5	637.7	89.3	66.0						
Balance Sheet (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Cash & cash equiv.	22,062	37,416	44,719	50,715	56,903						
Accounts receivables	3,478	3,839	4,247	4,703	5,200						
Inventory	12,198	11,618	12,702	12,805	12,557						
Net fixed & other tangibles	107,919	105,414	107,853	112,414	122,941						
Goodwill & intangibles	35,859	33,815	30,236	30,236	30,236						
Financial & other assets	14,969	19,327	21,357	21,357	21,357						
Total assets	196,485	211,429	221,113	232,229	249,194						
Accounts payable	12,556	9,882	9,482	9,543	9,383						
Short-term debt	3,729	2,499	2,004	2,004	2,004						
Long-term debt	46,282	44,086	43,027	43,027	43,027						
Provisions & other liab	28,886	28,602	28,153	28,153	28,153						
Total liabilities	91,453	85,069	82,666	82,727	82,567						
Shareholders' equity	105,032	126,360	138,448	149,502	166,627						
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0						
Total equity	105,032	126,360	138,448	149,502	166,627						
Net debt (Adj)	27,949	9,169	312	-5,684	-11,872						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	26.6	7.3	0.2	-3.8	-7.1						

For definitions of the items in this table, please click [here](#).

2Q26 Earnings Preview

We model 2Q26 sales/EPS of \$14.4B (up 6% QoQ)/\$0.24, above Consensus of \$14.36B/\$0.21 and we model 3Q26 sales/EPS of \$15.1B (up 5% QoQ)/\$0.29, above Consensus of \$15.06B/\$0.27 on CPU upside and opex discipline.

Figure 1. INTC 2Q26 and 3Q26 Estimates

INTC	2Q26			3Q26		
	Citi	Cons	Citi vs Cons	Citi	Cons	Citi vs. Cons
Sales	\$14,400	\$14,357	\$43	\$15,100	\$15,062	\$38
EPS	\$0.24	\$0.21	15%	\$0.29	\$0.27	10%

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Source: Citi Research, FactSet

CPU TAM of \$137B by 2030

We are modelling a CPU TAM of \$137B by 2030. We expect general purpose CPUs to grow at a 20% CAGR to \$51B in 2030, AI head nodes to grow at a 24% CAGR to \$24.4B in 2030, and agentic CPUs to grow at an 187% CAGR to \$61.3B in 2030. We model general purpose CPUs to represent 39% of the TAM in 2030, AI head nodes to represent 16% of the TAM in 2030, and agentic CPUs to represent 45% of the TAM by 2030. For reference, ARM forecasted a TAM of \$100B by 2030, AMD forecasted a TAM of \$120B by 2030, and Nvidia forecasted a TAM of \$200B. We model total server CPU units to grow from 29.2M units in 2025 to 63.2M units in 2030, or 17% CAGR. We believe Intel units could grow at 10% CAGR.

Figure 2. Citi CPU TAM Model (\$M)

TAM Estimates (\$M)	C25	C26E	C27E	C28E	C29E	C30E
General Purpose CPU	\$20,756	\$29,716	\$35,599	\$39,790	\$46,824	\$50,977
% of Total	71%	57%	50%	46%	42%	39%
YoY		42%	20%	13%	17%	9%
AI Headnodes	\$8,197	\$12,162	\$15,588	\$17,252	\$19,541	\$24,415
% of Total	28%	24%	22%	20%	17%	16%
YoY		48%	28%	11%	12%	10%
Agentic CPU Applications	\$313	\$10,079	\$19,154	\$29,244	\$46,449	\$61,309
% of Total	1%	19%	27%	34%	41%	45%
YoY		3086%	90%	54%	58%	29%
Total	\$29,266	\$51,957	\$70,341	\$86,286	\$112,815	\$136,700
YoY		76%	35%	24%	30%	18%

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Source: Citi Research, Mercury Research

Figure 3. Citi Server CPU Unit Model

Unit Model (M)	C25	C26E	C27E	C28E	C29E	C30E
CPU Units (M)	29,210	40,728	47,727	50,602	58,042	63,249
YoY	21%	39%	17%	6%	15%	9%
Intel	17,943	22,426	25,300	26,013	27,426	28,939
YoY	6%	25%	13%	3%	5%	6%
AMD	7,240	11,583	15,223	17,285	20,960	21,868
YoY	32%	60%	31%	14%	21%	4%
ARM/Others	4,027	6,719	7,204	7,304	9,655	12,442
YoY	127%	67%	7%	1%	32%	29%

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Source: Citi Research, Mercury Research

Figure 4. Citi PC Unit Model

Year	Form Factor	Citi Research		Citi Research	
		Units (M)	Y/Y	Revenues (\$ bln)	Y/Y
2022	Desktop	86	(11%)	60	(6%)
	Portable	208	(19%)	188	(15%)
	Total Client PCs	294	(17%)	248	(13%)
	Tablets (including 2 in 1)	162	(4%)	68	(1%)
	Total PCs + ALL Tablets	455	(13%)	316	(10%)
2023	Desktop	72	(16%)	49	(18%)
	Portable	181	(13%)	159	(15%)
	Total Client PCs	253	(14%)	209	(16%)
	Tablets (including 2 in 1)	129	(20%)	53	(22%)
	Total PCs + ALL Tablets	382	(16%)	262	(17%)
2024	Desktop	73	1%	51	2%
	Portable	189	4%	174	9%
	Total Client PCs	262	3%	225	8%
	Tablets (including 2 in 1)	145	12%	61	15%
	Total PCs + ALL Tablets	406	6%	286	9%
2025	Desktop	82	13%	60	18%
	Portable	203	8%	193	11%
	Total Client PCs	286	9%	253	12%
	Tablets (including 2 in 1)	152	5%	63	3%
	Total PCs + ALL Tablets	438	8%	315	10%
2026E	Desktop	68	(17%)	59	(1%)
	Portable	175	(14%)	196	2%
	Total Client PCs	244	(15%)	255	1%
	Tablets (including 2 in 1)	140	(8%)	59	(6%)
	Total PCs + ALL Tablets	384	(12%)	314	(0%)
2027E	Desktop	67	(1%)	59	1%
	Portable	175	(0%)	200	2%
	Total Client PCs	242	(0%)	259	2%
	Tablets (including 2 in 1)	140	(0%)	60	2%
	Total PCs + ALL Tablets	382	(0%)	320	2%

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports

Valuation

Figure 5. INTC – SOTP Valuation Analysis

SOTP	2026E	2027E	2028E	P/E
CCG	\$28	\$28	\$35	15
DCAI	\$41	\$56	\$73	30
Intel Foundry	-\$5	-\$1	\$18	35
All Other (Mobileye/IMS/Other)	\$1	\$1	\$1	15
Net Cash Per Share	\$0	\$1	\$2	
Total			\$130	

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, Mercury Research

Companies Mentioned:

Advanced Micro Devices (AMD.O; US\$548.13; 1; 14 Jul 26; 16:00) | Alphabet Inc (GOOGL.O; US\$359.51; 1; 14 Jul 26; 16:00) | Apple, Inc. (AAPL.O; US\$314.86; 1; 14 Jul 26; 16:00) | Arm Holdings PLC (ARM.O; US\$281.17; 1; 14 Jul 26; 16:00) | Intel Corp (INTC.O; US\$107.76; 1; 14 Jul 26; 16:00) | Mediatek (2454.TW; NT\$3660.0; 1; 14 Jul 26; 13:30) | NVIDIA Corp (NVDA.O; US\$211.8; 1; 14 Jul 26; 16:00) | Space Exploration Technologies (SPCX.O; US\$136.08; 1; 14 Jul 26; 16:00)

Intel Corp

Company description

Intel is a semiconductor company that specializes in microprocessors and is the #1 supplier of microprocessors for desktop PCs, notebook PCs, and servers with approximately 60% total market share. Intel also has a foundry business. Based in Santa Clara, CA, Intel has roughly 83,200 employees worldwide. Intel derives approximately 90% of its total revenue and 90% of total profits from the PC and Datacenter segments. Intel is a vertically integrated device manufacturer (IDM) with front-end wafer fabrication facilities in Oregon, Arizona, New Mexico, China, Ireland, and Israel and back-end assembly and test operations in Malaysia, China, Costa Rica, and Vietnam.

Investment strategy

We are Buy rated on Intel shares given the AI-driven CPU cycle and we're more positive on Intel foundry given better execution by Intel management.

Valuation

We value INTC based on our SOTP valuation, our price target is \$130. We apply a SOTP valuation framework to each of Intel's reportable segments and to highlight our growth expectations for Intel Foundry.

Risks

PC end-market: Intel derives roughly 90% of sales from the PC and server segments, which are highly dependent on IT spending. Therefore, any major uptick/downtick in IT spending could result in upside/downside to our estimates and cause us to reassess our rating on INTC.

M&A: If Intel engages in a substantial accretive acquisition, it could result in upside to our estimates.

Competition: Intel competes directly with AMD in the microprocessor market. Consequently, any fluctuations in market share between Intel and AMD could result in risk to our estimates.

Customer risk: Intel's largest PC OEM customers collectively represent roughly 45% Intel's revenue. As a result, any major declines in orders from PC OEMs could have a negative effect on our estimates for Intel.

Macroeconomic: Intel's geographic exposure spans multiple geographies including the U.S., Europe, and Asia. As a result, any prolonged macroeconomic downturn/upturn could result in downside/upside to our estimates and rating.

If the impact from the above risks turns out to be greater/less than we anticipate, the shares could fail to achieve or could exceed our target price.

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Appendix A-1

ANALYST CERTIFICATION

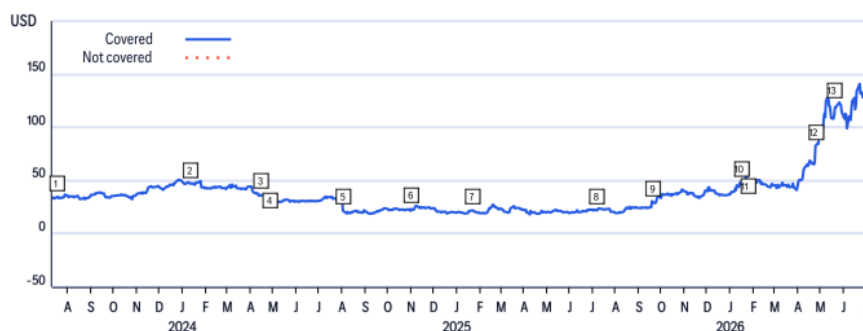
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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Intel Corp (INTC)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	17-Jul-23 07:11:15	2	*34.00	34.37
2	12-Jan-24 06:06:09	2	*47.50	47.12
3	15-Apr-24 06:04:21	2	*40.00	36.31
4	26-Apr-24 03:00:00	2	*35.00	31.88
5	02-Aug-24 08:05:49	2	*25.00	21.48

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
6	01-Nov-24 03:17:08	2	*22.00	23.20
7	21-Jan-25 03:00:00	2	*21.00	21.77
8	07-Jul-25 03:00:00	2	*24.00	22.00
9	19-Sep-25 02:10:39	*3	*29.00	29.58
10	15-Jan-26 07:24:43	*2	*50.00	48.32

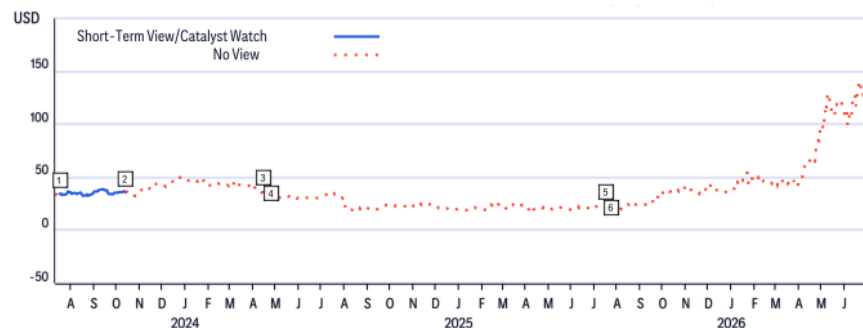
	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
11	23-Jan-26 01:48:19	2	*48.00	45.07
12	24-Apr-26 06:29:21	*1	*95.00	82.54
13	18-May-26 05:00:00	1	*130.00	108.17

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Intel Corp (INTC)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	17-Jul-23 03:11:15	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	34.37
2	15-Oct-23 12:07:05	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	35.97

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
3	15-Apr-24 02:04:21	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	36.31
4	25-Apr-24 23:00:00	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	35.11

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
5	17-Jul-25 23:00:00	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	22.80
6	24-Jul-25 23:00:00	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	22.63

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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James Bowlin, Senior Associate, used to be an officer, director or employee of Intel Corp.

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Citi Research Equity Ratings Distribution

Data current as of 01 Jul 2026	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
Citi Research Global Fundamental Coverage (Neutral=Hold)	61%	32%	7%	36%	48%	16%
% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	38%	42%	27%	42%	37%	36%

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